



Judging Criteria and Scoring Guide

Tatweer Hackathon . For the judging panel

26 to 28 June 2026 . Al Qua'a, Al Ain . In collaboration with Abu Dhabi University

This guide is for the judging panel. It sets out what teams submit, how the two rounds work, the criteria with score bands, and how scores combine to rank teams. Please review and tell us if you would add or adjust anything.

How the rounds work

Round one, filtration. Saturday from 10:00 PM, scored from each team's GitHub repository. All teams are scored on criteria 1 to 7. The total ranks the teams, and the top 10 advance.

Round two, final. Sunday, the top 10 present live. The same criteria are re-scored on what is shown live, and criterion 8, presentation and live demo, is added. Highest totals win.

What teams submit

Every team submits one public GitHub repository, regardless of project type. A drone, a website, a robot, an app, or a research study all go in the repo: code, files, documents, and a demo video. The repo link is submitted through a form before Saturday 8:00 PM GST. Only commits made before 8:00 PM count. AI and all other tools are permitted with no restrictions.

Each repository README is required to cover: the challenge, the problem, the target demographic, the situation, the solution, the impact and its testable claims, feasibility and deployment, scalability, how to run or verify it, the tools used, and any evidence or validation. These sections map directly to the criteria below.

How scoring works

Each judge scores every criterion on its own scale using the bands provided. Scores are summed per judge, then averaged across judges to give each team's total. Teams are ranked by total.

Filtration total: 65 points

Final total: 75 points

- Tiebreak order: Impact first, then Feasibility.
- In filtration, judges may split the teams between them and pool the scores, given the number of submissions.
- A criterion with no evidence in the repo is scored in its lowest band, not skipped.

The criteria

1 Impact and value to the community

10 pts

The size and realness of the benefit to the target group.

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|---------|--|
| 0 to 2 | No clear beneficiary or benefit. Impact is asserted but not tied to a real need. |
| 3 to 5 | Some benefit, but narrow, marginal, or weakly tied to a real need. |
| 6 to 8 | Clear, meaningful benefit to a defined group, addressing a genuine need. |
| 9 to 10 | Substantial benefit to many, addressing a pressing need, with the difference it makes clearly articulated. |

2 Relevance to the challenge

10 pts

How directly it addresses the rural digital infrastructure track and a real problem within it.

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|---------|---|
| 0 to 2 | Off topic or only loosely connected to the challenge. |
| 3 to 5 | Related, but the link to the challenge is partial or generic. |
| 6 to 8 | Clearly addresses the challenge and a specific problem within it. |
| 9 to 10 | Squarely on the challenge, targeting a well chosen, high value problem. |

3 Feasibility of implementation

10 pts

Whether it can realistically be deployed in the real context, considering cost, resources, and maintenance.

- 0 to 2 Not implementable in any realistic setting, or ignores cost and resources entirely.
- 3 to 5 Implementable only with major unaddressed obstacles or unrealistic assumptions.
- 6 to 8 Implementable with reasonable resources, main constraints acknowledged.
- 9 to 10 Clearly deployable in a rural setting, with cost, resources, and maintenance thought through.

4 Readiness of the solution

10 pts

How complete and functional the solution is now.

- 0 to 2 Idea only, nothing built.
- 3 to 5 Early prototype or partial mockup, not demonstrable end to end.
- 6 to 8 Working build that demonstrates the core function.
- 9 to 10 Complete, working solution demonstrated end to end.

5 Scalability after the hackathon

10 pts

Whether it can grow beyond the event and replicate to other communities.

- 0 to 2 One off, cannot grow or repeat.
- 3 to 5 Could grow, but with serious technical or operational limits.
- 6 to 8 Scales to more users or sites with manageable effort.
- 9 to 10 Designed to scale and replicate, with a clear path to growth.

6 Falsifiability and evidence

10 pts

Whether the team makes specific, testable claims backed by evidence, rather than vague hype.

- 0 to 2 Vague, unfalsifiable claims, no evidence.
- 3 to 5 Some claims are specific, but largely unsupported.
- 6 to 8 Clear, testable claims with some supporting evidence or testing.
- 9 to 10 Specific, testable claims backed by data, testing, or community validation.

7 Repo documentation and completeness

5 pts

Whether the repo contains everything needed to understand and verify the work. Light weight.

- 0 to 1 Sparse or missing README, hard to understand.
- 2 to 3 README present but incomplete, gaps in what is needed to verify.
- 4 to 5 Complete README and repo, everything present to understand, run, or verify, including demo material.

Sunday final, additional criterion

8 Presentation and live demo

10 pts

Sunday final only. Clarity of the live demonstration and how well the team answers questions.

- 0 to 2 Unclear, no working demonstration, cannot answer questions.
- 3 to 5 Basic presentation, partial demo, weak on questions.
- 6 to 8 Clear presentation, working demo, handles most questions well.
- 9 to 10 Compelling presentation, strong working demo, credible under questioning.

Score sheet, filtration round (per team)

Criterion	Max	Score
Impact and value to the community	10	
Relevance to the challenge	10	
Feasibility of implementation	10	
Readiness of the solution	10	
Scalability after the hackathon	10	
Falsifiability and evidence	10	
Repo documentation and completeness	5	
Total	65	

Team name and judge name to be recorded at the top of each sheet.

Score sheet, Sunday final (top 10)

Criterion	Max	Score
Impact and value to the community	10	
Relevance to the challenge	10	
Feasibility of implementation	10	
Readiness of the solution	10	
Scalability after the hackathon	10	
Falsifiability and evidence	10	
Repo documentation and completeness	5	
Presentation and live demo (Sunday only)	10	
Total	75	